HIGH-HYDRATION PIZZA DOUGH FOR A HOME OVEN

MAKES	ACTIVE TIME	REST
3 balls of 260 g	**20 min across the folds**	**12 h cold, then a few hours at room temperature**

INGREDIENTS

230 g	All-purpose flour
230 g	Bread flour
330 g	Water
15 g	Extra-virgin olive oil
8 g	Salt
5 g	Sugar
0.5 g	Fresh yeast

METHOD

1. Stir the two flours together with the sugar.
2. Dissolve the yeast in the water, then pour that over the flour along with the oil and the salt.
3. Squeeze everything through your hands for about 30 seconds, until no dry flour is left. It will be slack and it will stick. Cover and leave 15 to 20 minutes.
4. First round of folds: wet your hands, run them down the inside of the bowl to release the dough, lift it, let it drop and fold it under itself. Turn the bowl a quarter and repeat until the ball will not take another fold. Cover, 15 minutes.
5. Second round, the same way. Keep going in 15-minute rounds, three or four of them if that is what it takes, until the surface is smooth and the ball has spread too wide and relaxed to fold again.
6. Cover and refrigerate 12 hours, overnight.
7. Turn the cold dough onto a lightly damp bench and divide into three balls of about 260 g.
8. Leave them at room temperature until they have grown, gone airy and slumped a little. Judge this by eye, not by the clock, because it depends entirely on how warm your kitchen is.

NOTES

330 g of water against 460 g of flour is 72% hydration, well above the 62 to 63% of a classic Neapolitan dough. The extra water is there because a home oven needs about six minutes rather than ninety seconds, and a drier dough comes out of that bake like a rock.
The two flours do different jobs. Bread flour carries the long ferment and supplies elasticity, all-purpose keeps the dough extensible so it stretches without fighting back. Both are ordinary supermarket flours, nothing specialist.
Sugar and olive oil are both departures from a classic Neapolitan dough. The sugar browns a rim in an oven that cannot char it, the oil buys extensibility.
If the dough stays lumpy and soupy and never comes smooth, your flour will not carry this much water. Drop 40 to 50 g of it and keep everything else the same.
0.5 g of fresh yeast is a piece about the size of a dried chickpea. Dry yeast is far stronger, so barely the tip of a spoon.
There is no mixer in this. All the structure comes from the folds and the rests.
Balls that never grow mean the yeast was dead, or the kitchen is cold enough that this little yeast cannot do the job.

PRESERVING

Freeze whatever you will not bake. The cold ferment already carries the dough a day, so freezing is the answer past that rather than stretching it further.
Freeze after dividing, each ball wrapped tight and then bagged.
Thaw overnight in the fridge, then bring it to room temperature and let the second rise finish before you stretch it.
Do not refreeze a thawed ball.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

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